

What Are We Actually Building?

Before a single line of code — understand **what an AI agent is**. Copy-paste that works without understanding isn't enough.



You've Used ChatGPT, Right?



How it works

You type → it replies. One shot, one response. No follow-through. No initiative.

⚠ That's a **chatbot** — not an agent.

So what actually makes something an **agent**?

Think of a Junior Employee

Your manager says: *"Find out why this customer's order is late."*

1

Check the system

2

Gather info

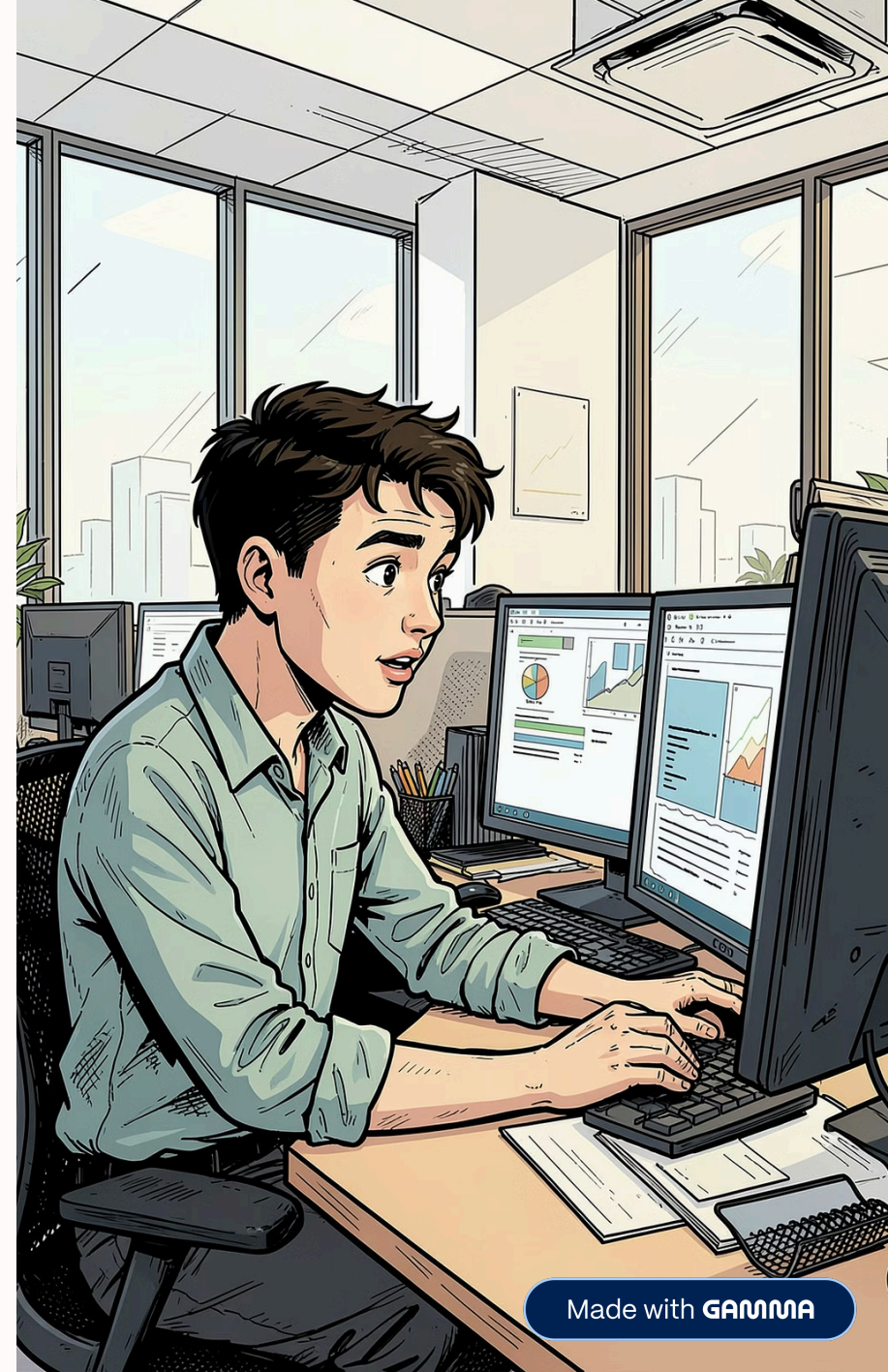
3

Think it through

4

Report back

That process — act, gather, think, report — **that is exactly what an AI agent does.**



The Core Difference



Chatbot

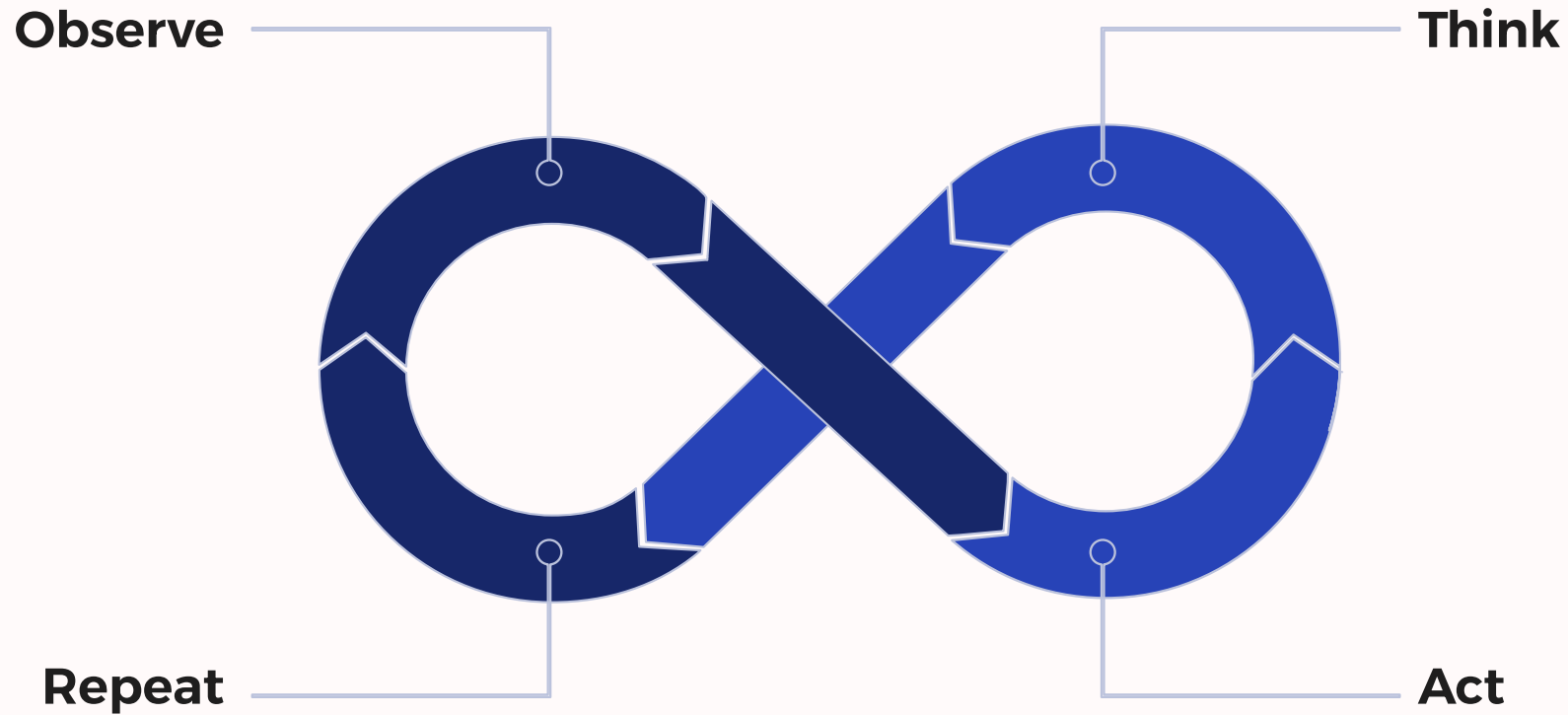
Responds. One input, one output. Done.



Agent

Acts. Loops until the job is done.

The Agent Loop



A chatbot does one step. An agent keeps looping — **observe, think, act** — until the task is complete.



In Our Project

Customer says: *"My order hasn't arrived — I want a refund."*

01

Check order status & courier

02

Review refund history

03

Escalate to manager agent

04

Return final reply

All of that — **autonomously**. No human directing each step.

One-Line Definition

An AI agent is a system that can **perceive** its environment, **make decisions**, **take actions**, and work towards a goal — **autonomously**.

Perceive

Reads the situation

Decide

Figures out next steps

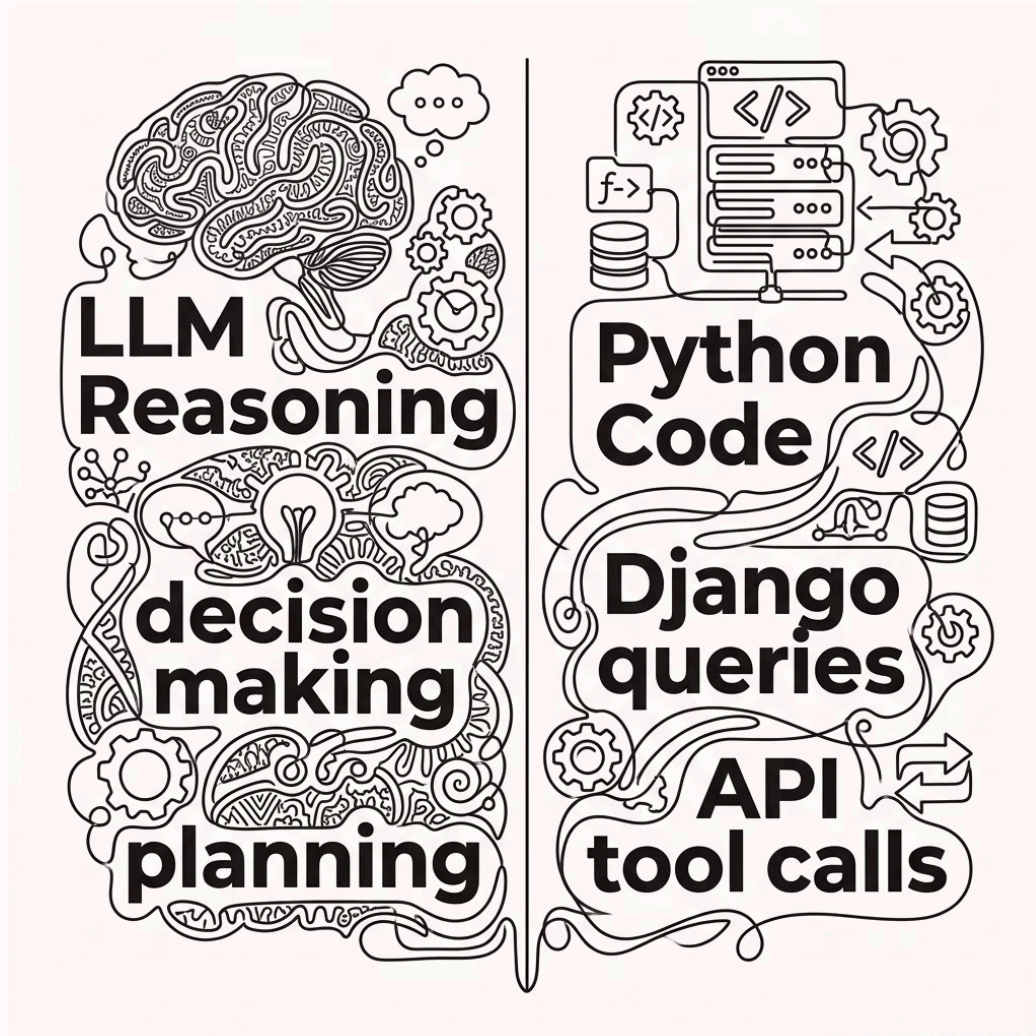
Act

Calls tools, queries data

Repeat

Until the goal is reached

Where Does Django Fit?

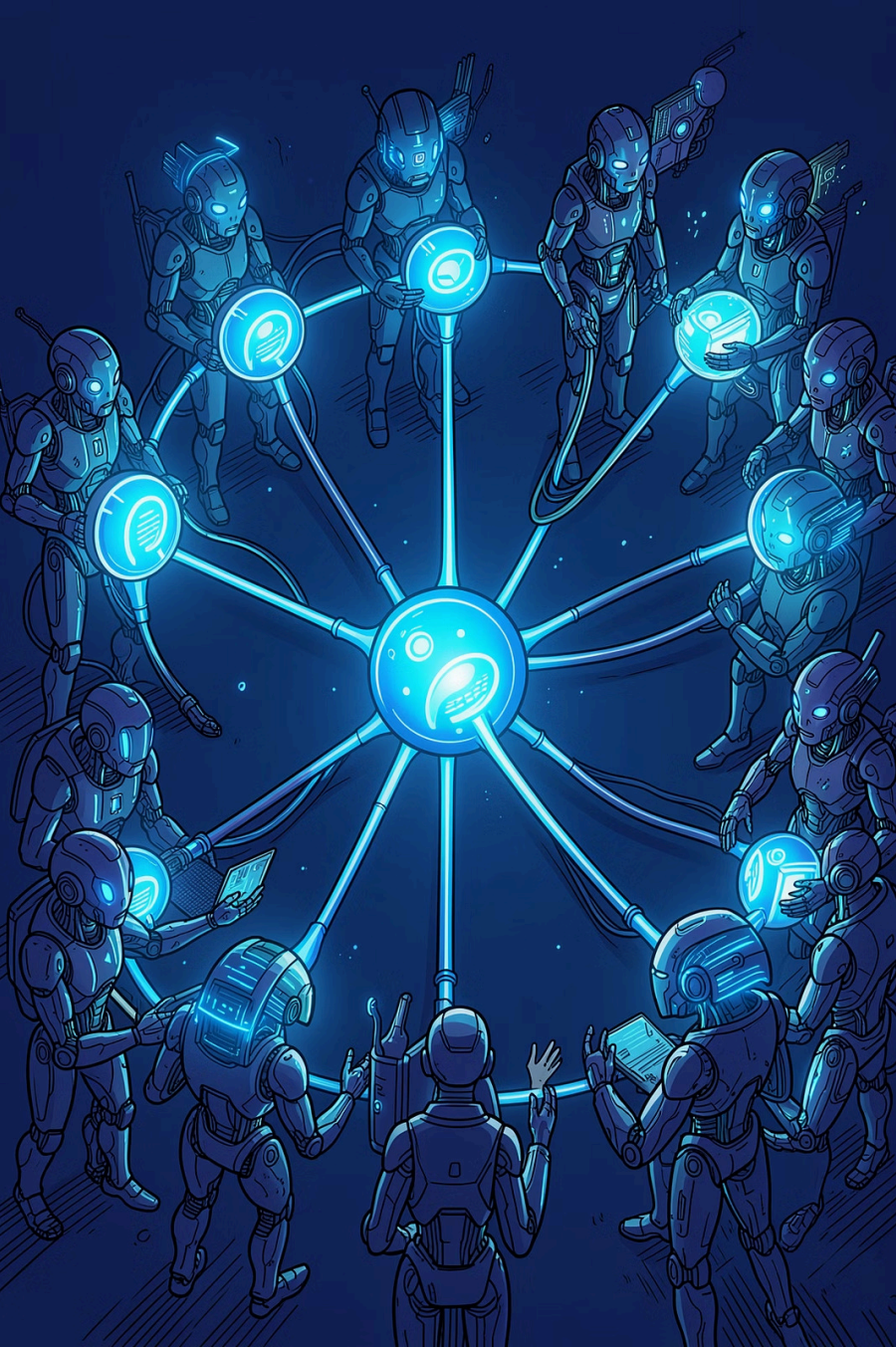


You build the tools

The LLM handles intelligence. You handle **action**.

Your Django ORM queries *are* the agent's tools. The agent decides **when** to use them.

✅ That's where your power as a developer lives.



Up Next: Multiple Agents

What happens when **agents work together** — collaborating, delegating, escalating?

NEXT LESSON

That's where things get **really interesting**.